Ancient Korea

Korea is situated on the eastern peninsula of the continent and has been occupied by humans since the Neolithic era. During the latter part of the first millennium BCE, a new state emerged by the name of Gojoseon. This is known as the first state in Korean history. Between the first century BCE and the seventh century CE, this region was under the control of three kingdoms: Silla, Goguryeo and Baekje. With help from the Chinese, Silla was able to conquer the other kingdoms and rule the peninsula completely. It established a Unified Silla Kingdom until it fell in 935 CE. The Goryeo kingdom ruled Korea next until the Mongol armies conquered the region in the 13th century.

Despite periods of tension and warfare, the kingdoms of Korea and China forged close relations with each other for mutual benefit. Japan also traded with its neighbor and was able to maintain ties with Korea. Over the centuries, Ancient Korea has contributed to many human achievements including portable metal printing and the stunning Silla gold crowns. It also came up with hanjie, which was one of the most famous types of paper and the ondol, which was an underground heating system.